

A success story

Rajendra S. Pawar and Vijay K. Thadani shared the same dorm room in the campus of Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi in 1981. They decided to join hands and started NIIT the same year.



The Mantra for Career in Web Development

You don't qualify as a geek by merely supporting thick-framed glasses, cardigans and T-shirts with rather nerdy references to "geek-chic." It is a highly competitive world, where you have to deliver in order to make a mark for yourself.

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Being the most visible part of the global IT industry, web development is certainly a promising career option. According to the Bureau of Labour Statistics in USA, web development is going to be the fastest growing occupation over the next decade. The computer scientists and database administrators occupation is expected to grow at a rate that is much faster than the average for all other occupations. The computer industry is fully globalised so we can expect similar growth figures for India. There is no fixed path that you

can take in order to become a successful web developer. Some people attend classes and take degree or certification courses, while others can be completely self-taught. A fresher can easily expect a salary in the range of ₹1 lakh to 5 lakh per annum and there exists excellent chances for growth depending on the performance. It is possible for a fresher to become a senior level developer in 5 to 7 years, in which case his salary could even go up to 10 to 15 lakh per annum or more than that," says Manisha Jaggi, In charge of NIIT centre at Cannaught Place, New Delhi. "Computer professionals holding B.Sc degrees are offered much better pay packages. However,

for freelance professions the initial income may depend upon their business acumen and level of contacts."

Many students prefer to branch out as a freelancer. Becoming a freelancer and starting your own web development business can be as simple as setting up a web site and advertising your capabilities through social networking sites. If you are able to convince a sufficient number of clients to contract out their development work to you, then you can flourish. But if development is your sole means of support, then things can get pretty scary at times. Freelancers have to be prepared for going through the vagaries of ups and downs. On some months you will have more work than you can probably handle and on others you might have nothing at all.

Skills that you must know

A developer's task is not confined to merely putting up an interface on the Internet; the scope of this term is really large. The myriad jobs that a web developer might be expected to perform include database-management, web writing, editing, computer programming, web programming, graphic designing, 2D Animations and SEO/SEM. If you choose to join a corporation, your job title might actually depend on the exact nature of the job that you are performing in office. You could have the title of Computer Scientist or Database Administrator; you might also be known as a Web Designer, Web Developer, Web Writer or Web Producer. The skills that you need to master in order to fulfil the requirements of these jobs is equally vast. "These days the basic skills that the companies look for is Flash, Dreamweaver, HTML," says Anju Dalal of Arena. "Knowledge of scripting languages is also necessary."

To be a web developer, the most basic thing that you need to know is HTML. Just because the market is deluged with WYSIWYG programs, it doesn't mean you can afford to forget HTML. This is the basic building block of any web page, so it is in your interest to master it. The second thing that you need to master is CSS, which is what powers the myriad web designs and determines